

Mrs. Corazon Aczon
Middle School Religion
Mary, Star of the Sea School
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MSOS 2026-2027

Religion — Grade 8 Syllabus

Grade 8 — Blest Are We: The Story of Our Church

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

"You have been told, O mortal, what is good, and what the Lord requires of you: Only to do justice and to love goodness, and to walk humbly with your God." — Micah 6:8

Objectives

This course is based on the Ministry of Catechesis for religious education and faith formation: believe, worship, live, and pray. Students learn the doctrine of the Catholic Church and establish a common language of faith, engage with the sacramental life of the Catholic Church, focus on the moral teachings of the Church, and experience a wide variety of prayers.

Students will develop a deeper understanding of faith and a greater love for God.

Schoolwide Learning Expectation (SLE): MSOS students will become active Christians who respect others, make good choices, value prayer, and practice the teachings of the Catholic Church.

Course Outline

Grade 8 — Blest Are We: The Story of Our Church

- Unit 1 — The Marks of the Church
- Unit 2 — The Growth of Christendom
- Unit 3 — The Age of Faith and Beauty
- Unit 4 — Reason, Rebellion, and Reform
- Unit 5 — Returning to the Roots of Christianity

We Nurture Our Faith in Religion Class by:

- Praying and singing hymns
- Reading the Scriptures and memorizing Bible Verses
- Praying from the Book of Psalms
- Writing a “Dear God” journal
- Reflecting on the Readings and Gospel of the Day
- Reading, discussing, and answering activities (Blest Are We textbook)
- Role-playing Bible Stories (i.e., Christmas story)
- Learning about the Lives of Saints as models of Faith
- Praying the Rosary, Stations of the Cross, and other devotions
- Integrating Religion and Art by illustrating Bible Verses
- Participating in the Sacraments and celebration of the Liturgical Year as church ministers (lectors, choir, altar servers)
- Living God’s Word in and outside the classroom

Classroom Materials

Blest Are We (textbook), Holy Bible, usccb.org, computer, composition notebook, pencils/pens, agenda, colored pencils, highlighters.

Evaluation / Assessment

Tests & Quizzes	20%
Quarterly Tests	30%
Participation / Recitation, Writing Journals	30%
Homework	10%
Projects	10%
TOTAL	100%

Student Absence

Students will be responsible for turning in homework, assignments, and projects, and arranging with the teacher a specific time to make up any quizzes or tests missed due to absence.

GOD BLESS YOU!